controls for positive and negative tests. All of this in a matter of weeks! On 18 March, they consolidated their data and submitted their test kit to the ICMR for approval. The next day, Minal was in labour. However, at the end of her difficult pregnancy, which was laced with complications, she delivered a healthy baby girl. Six days later, on 26 March, ICMR approved the testing kit that Mylab submitted after which the company went on to manufacture millions of kits in a matter of weeks. Not only did the kit yield results with commendable accuracy, it was also half the price of the imported test kits and delivered PCR results in half the time. In a matter of weeks, the company began to manufacture over 2 million test kits per week, catering to the rising demand of India's testing needs at a critical juncture in the COVID-19 crisis.

When media broke the news, inspiring many young girls and several citizens to turn to problem-solving, igniting a ray of hope in dejected citizens, Minal in her interviews would say, 'It's like I've just had two babies! Despite complications in my pregnancy, it was my national duty to do this!'[25]

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28 MARCH 2020

INDIA | 878 ACTIVE CASES | 25 DEATHS

WORLD | 5,87,695 ACTIVE CASES | 332,799 DEATHS

Earlier in the week, the Ministry of Home Affairs, after confirming that Tablighi missionaries who had spread out to different parts of the country were testing positive, sent out an intimation of the developments to all state governments. The order issued specifically asked the state governments to track down and test the returnees from the Markaz as well as people they have come in contact with in the community.

Ever since the ban on religious gatherings announced by CM Arvind Kejriwal on 16 March, the Delhi Police and more specifically the officers of the Hazrat Nizamuddin Police Station, had been engaged in the exercise of persuading those still within the Markaz Masjid to evacuate the premises. Though the Markaz officials said that over 1,500 people had left the building, over 1,000 missionaries were still housed within. Various states in the country were reporting increased cases in the community, linking them